EXP 2	Design of the Books Form

Aim:

To design the Books form that stores the catalogue of the library together with the stock of every title.

Theory:

A form in Zoho Creator defines both the data-entry screen and the underlying table. Field types control the data that can be stored.

- **Auto Number:** Book ID is generated automatically starting from 101.
- **Unique field:** ISBN is marked unique so the same title cannot be catalogued twice.
- **Mandatory fields:** Book Title, Author, Category and Total Copies are mandatory (must have).
- **Stock fields:** Total Copies holds the number of copies owned; Available Copies holds the copies currently on the shelf and is maintained by workflows.

Fields of the Books form:

Field	Type	Rule
Book ID	Auto Number	Starts at 101
ISBN	Single Line	Unique
Book Title	Single Line	Mandatory
Author	Single Line	Mandatory
Category	Drop Down	Fiction / Science / Technology / History / General
Publisher	Single Line	Optional
Total Copies	Number	Mandatory, greater than 0
Available Copies	Number	Set by workflow, 0 to Total Copies
Shelf Location	Single Line	Optional

Procedure:

1. In the builder click + and create a new form named Books.
2. Add the fields listed in the table with the field types shown.
3. Open Settings > Application IDE > Books and set the display names, the unique ISBN rule, the mandatory fields, the Category choices and the Book ID start index.
4. Group the fields into two sections: Book Details and Stock Details.
5. Save the script and open the form in the live application to check the layout.

Program (Books form definition - Application IDE):

```
form Books
{
    displayname = "Books"
    success message = "Book saved successfully!"
    Section
    (
        type = section
```

```
        displayname = "Book Details"
    )
    Book_ID
    (
        type = autonumber
        displayname = "Book ID"
        start index = 101
    )
    unique ISBN
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "ISBN"
    )
    must have Book_Title
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "Book Title"
    )
    must have Author
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "Author"
    )
    must have Category
    (
        type = picklist
        displayname = "Category"
        values = {"Fiction","Science","Technology","History","General"}
    )
    Publisher
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "Publisher"
    )
    Stock_Details
    (
        type = section
        displayname = "Stock Details"
    )
    must have Total_Copies
    (
        type = number
        displayname = "Total Copies"
    )
    Available_Copies
    (
        type = number
        displayname = "Available Copies"
    )
    Single_Line
    (
        type = text
        displayname = "Shelf Location"
    )
}
```

Output:

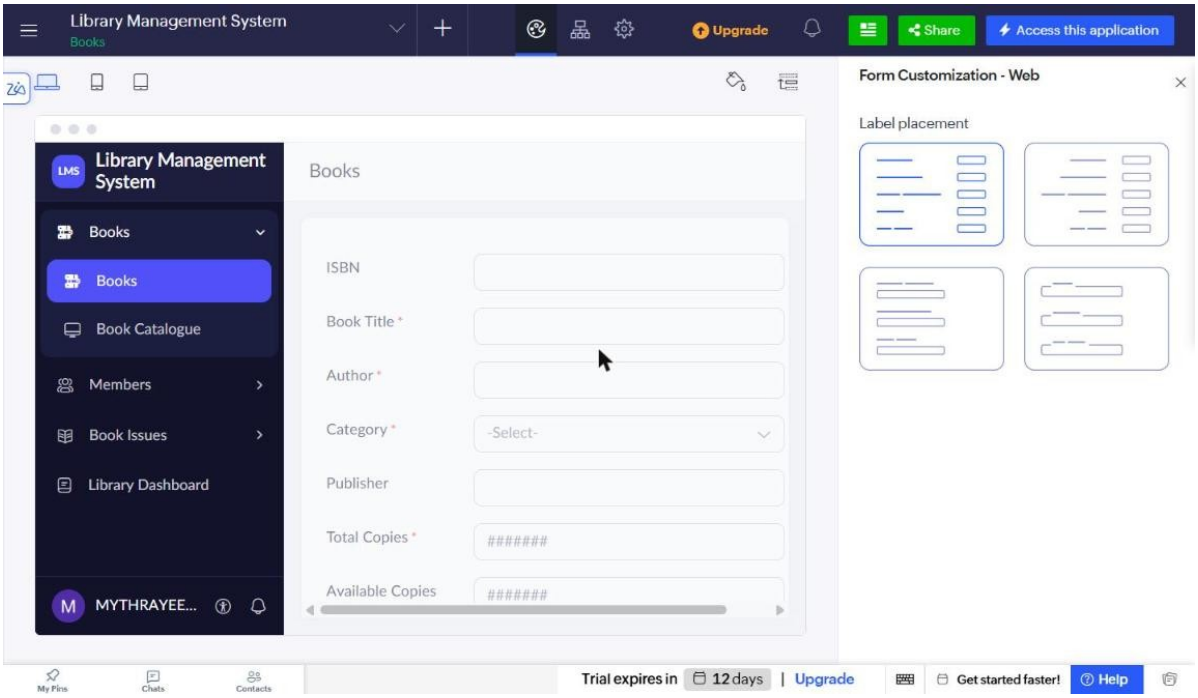


Fig. 2.1: Books form in the form builder

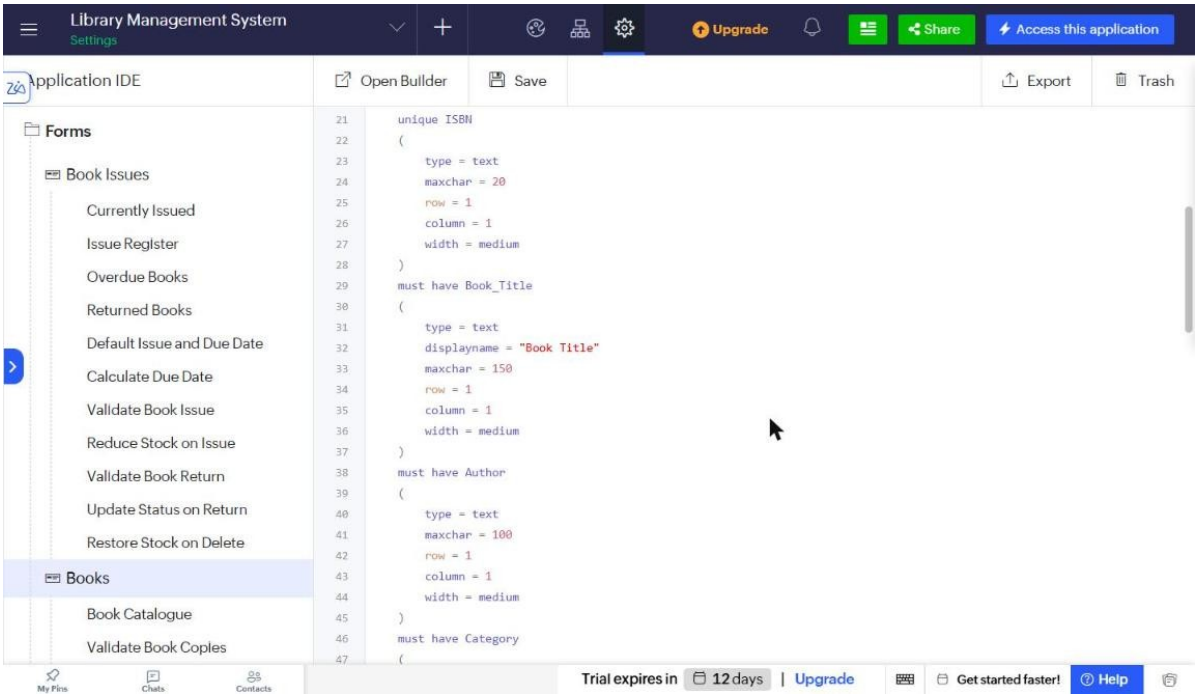


Fig. 2.2: Books form fields in the Application IDE

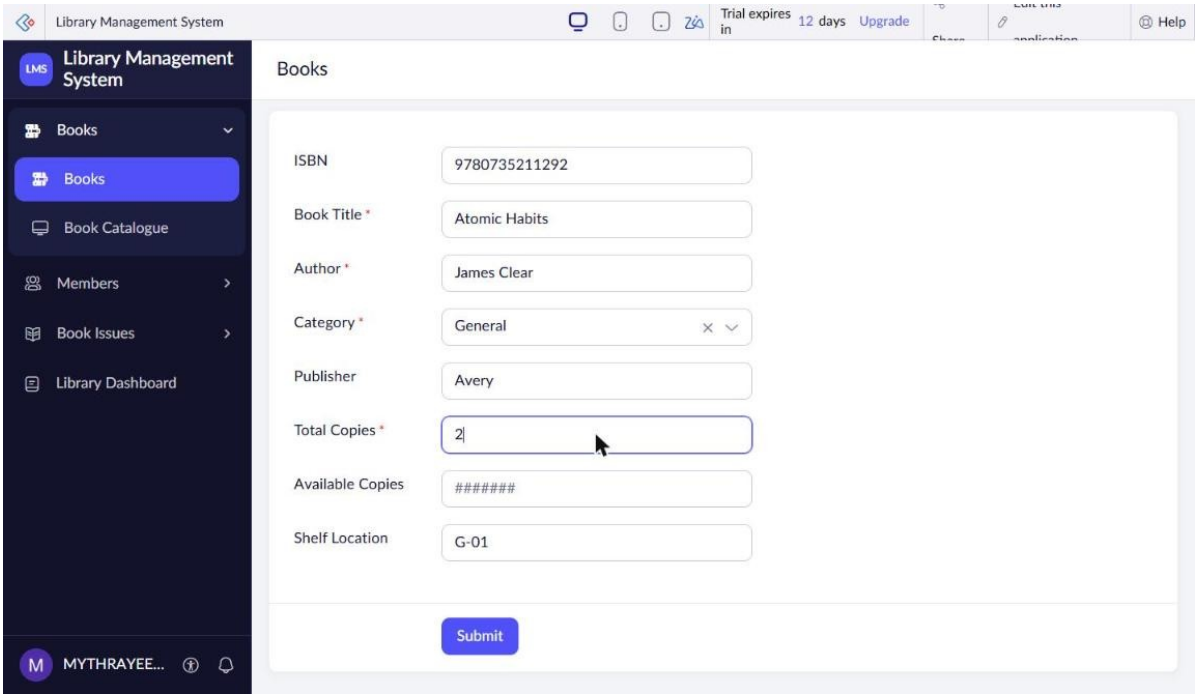


Fig. 2.3: Books form in the live application

Result:

The Books form was designed with an auto-generated Book ID, a unique ISBN, mandatory catalogue fields and the Total/Available Copies stock fields.